

By **Ashwini Vaishnaw**

THE NEW FRONTIERS OF AI

WITH THE FIFTH INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION UPON US, INDIA IS BUILDING THE FULL AI STACK. IT WILL MAKE AI WORK AT SCALE BUT ROOTED IN INDIA'S REALITIES, AND LEAVING A REAL IMPACT ON PEOPLE'S LIVES

In

In 1950, the mathematician and computer scientist Alan Turing asked a question far ahead of his time: can machines think? It was an era when computers functioned like mechanical calculators, capable of processing numbers but not ideas. He argued that intelligence lies in the ability to learn, reason and act intelligently, rather than by consciousness or emotions.

This idea came decades before computing power, data and algorithms could make it possible. Yet it introduced the world to the concept of intelligent machines. At the dawn of 2026, this journey reached a new phase of human progress—the Fifth Industrial Revolution—defined by Artificial Intelligence (AI) and its deep integration into everyday life.

Illustrations by **NILANJAN DAS / AI**

